ENGLISH I FINAL EXAM

Theme & Vocabulary in Context

Part I: Literature – *To Kill a Mockingbird*

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1. (RL.9-10.4) Multiple Choice

Excerpt: "You never really understand a person until you consider things from his point of view… until you climb into his skin and walk around in it."

The phrase "climb into his skin and walk around in it" most nearly means:

A. Spy on someone secretly B. Physically fight someone C. Show empathy by understanding another's perspective D. Change someone's personality

2. ~~(RL.9-10.2) Short Response~~

~~Based on the excerpt above, identify one theme of the novel and explain how this quote helps develop that theme.~~

3. ~~(RL.9-10.4) Fill in the Blank~~

~~Excerpt: "Atticus was feeble: he was nearly fifty."~~

~~In this context, the word feeble most nearly means: _____.~~

4. ~~(RL.9-10.2) Multiple Choice~~

~~Excerpt (Atticus defending Tom Robinson): "In the name of God, do your duty."~~

~~Which theme is most strongly reinforced in this moment?~~

~~A. Childhood innocence B. Moral courage in the face of injustice C. Family loyalty D. Fear of the unknown~~

5. (RL.9-10.4) Multiple Choice

Excerpt describing Maycomb during the Great Depression: "Maycomb was an old town, but it was a tired old town when I first knew it."

The word tired most strongly suggests:

A. Physically exhausted citizens B. A community worn down by hardship C. A lazy population D. A town ready for change

6. (RL.9-10.2) Short Response

~~Explain how the setting of Maycomb during the Great Depression contributes to a central theme of the novel.~~

7. (RL.9-10.4) Fill in the Blank

Excerpt: "Jem's growing up was hard enough without having to learn from scratch that when a white man says something against a Black man's word, the white man always wins."

The phrase "learn from scratch" most nearly means: _____.

8. ~~(RL.9-10.2) Multiple Choice~~

~~Throughout the novel, the mockingbird symbolizes:~~

~~A. Intelligence B. Innocence harmed by evil C. Wealth and power D. Southern tradition~~

Part II: Informational Texts & Historical Context

9. ~~(RI.9-10.2) Multiple Choice~~

~~Excerpt about the Scottsboro Boys: "In 1931, nine Black teenagers were falsely accused of assault. Despite weak evidence, all-white juries quickly convicted them."~~

~~The central idea of this excerpt is:~~

~~A. The legal system works efficiently. B. The boys were guilty of their crimes. C. Racial prejudice influenced the trials and verdicts. D. The South had strong juries.~~

10. ~~(RI.9-10.4) Fill in the Blank~~

~~In the sentence above, the word convicted most nearly means: _____.~~

~~11. (RI.9-10.2) Short Response~~

~~Explain how the Scottsboro case provides historical context for To Kill a Mockingbird.~~

~~12. (RI.9-10.2) Multiple Choice~~

~~Excerpt about Emmett Till: "In 1955, Emmett Till's murder and the acquittal of his killers shocked the nation and became a catalyst for the Civil Rights Movement."~~

~~The phrase catalyst suggests that the event:~~

~~A. Ended racial injustice B. Caused immediate equality C. Sparked or accelerated change D. Was quickly forgotten~~

~~13. (RI.9-10.4) Fill in the Blank~~

~~The word acquittal most nearly means: _____.~~

~~14. (RI.9-10.2) Multiple Choice~~

~~Excerpt about Harper Lee: "Harper Lee grew up in Alabama and observed racial inequality firsthand, experiences that later shaped her writing."~~

~~The central idea is:~~

~~A. Lee preferred nonfiction writing. B. Lee's childhood influenced the themes in her novel. C. Lee disliked Alabama. D. Lee based her novel entirely on fiction.~~

~~15. (RI.9-10.4) Multiple Choice~~

~~Excerpt about the Great Depression: "Widespread unemployment left many families destitute."~~

~~The word destitute most nearly means:~~

~~A. Wealthy B. Independent C. Extremely poor D. Relieved~~

~~16. (RI.9-10.2) Short Response~~

~~How does understanding the Great Depression deepen a reader's understanding of Maycomb's attitudes and behaviors in the novel?~~

~~17. (RL.9-10.2 & RI.9-10.2) Extended Response~~

~~Compare the theme of justice in To Kill a Mockingbird with the historical events of the Scottsboro trials or Emmett Till case. How do both literary and informational texts develop the idea that the legal system can fail?~~

Part III: Research Writing & MLA 9 (W.9-10.9)

18. (W.9-10.9) Multiple Choice – In-Text Citation

Which of the following demonstrates correct MLA 9 in-text citation for a quote from To Kill a Mockingbird?

A. "Real courage is when you know you're licked before you begin…" (Lee 112).

B. "Real courage is when you know you're licked before you begin…" (Harper Lee, page 112).

C. "Real courage is when you know you're licked before you begin…" (pg. 112).

D. "Real courage is when you know you're licked before you begin…" (TKAM 112).

Answer: A

~~19. (W.9-10.9) Fill in the Blank – Signal Phrase~~

~~Rewrite the sentence using a correct MLA signal phrase:~~

~~"Mockingbirds don't do one thing but make music for us to enjoy" (Lee 119).~~

~~Corrected sentence: According to _____, "Mockingbirds don't do one thing but make music for us to enjoy" (119).~~

~~Answer: Harper Lee~~

20. (W.9-10.9) Multiple Choice – Punctuation with Citation

Which sentence correctly punctuates the quotation and citation?

A. Atticus argues that "the one place where a man ought to get a square deal is in a courtroom" (Lee 205).

B. Atticus argues that "the one place where a man ought to get a square deal is in a courtroom." (Lee 205)

C. Atticus argues that "the one place where a man ought to get a square deal is in a courtroom" Lee 205.

D. Atticus argues that "the one place where a man ought to get a square deal is in a courtroom." Lee (205).

Answer: A

~~21. (W.9-10.9) Short Response – Integrating Research~~

~~Write one sentence that properly integrates evidence from a nonfiction source about the Scottsboro Boys using a signal phrase and MLA parenthetical citation (author last name and page number format).~~

~~Answer (Sample Response): Historian James Carter explains that the Scottsboro defendants were denied fair trials due to racial prejudice, as "all-white juries rushed to conviction despite conflicting evidence" (Carter 42).~~

22. (W.9-10.9) Multiple Choice – Works Cited Entry

Which example correctly formats a Works Cited entry for the novel?

A. Lee, Harper. To Kill a Mockingbird. Harper Perennial Modern Classics, 2006.

B. Harper Lee. To Kill a Mockingbird. 2006.

C. Lee, Harper, To Kill a Mockingbird, Harper Perennial Modern Classics 2006.

D. Lee Harper. To Kill a Mockingbird Harper, 2006.

Answer: A

23. (W.9-10.9) Fill in the Blank – Hanging Indent

In MLA 9, every Works Cited entry after the first line should use a _____.

Answer: hanging indent

24. (W.9-10.9) Multiple Choice – Block Quote Formatting

When should a student format a quotation as a block quote in MLA 9?

A. When the quote is longer than 2 lines

B. When the quote is 4 or more lines of prose

C. When quoting dialogue

D. When citing a novel

Answer: B

25. (W.9-10.9) Short Response – Avoiding Plagiarism

~~Explain why including both a signal phrase and parenthetical citation is important in a formal research essay about To Kill a Mockingbird.~~

~~Answer (Sample Response): Including both a signal phrase and parenthetical citation gives credit to the original author, strengthens credibility, and prevents plagiarism by clearly showing which ideas and words come from the source.~~

26. (W.9-10.9) Multiple Choice – Citing a Web Source

Which in-text citation is correct for an online article about Emmett Till written by an author named Carter with no page numbers?

A. (Carter)

B. (Carter 4)

C. (www.history.com)

D. ("Emmett Till")

Answer: A

~~27. (W.9-10.9) Works Cited Construction~~

~~Create a correctly formatted MLA 9 Works Cited entry for an article with the following information:~~

~~Author: James Carter~~

~~Title: "The Impact of the Scottsboro Trials"~~

~~Website: History Today~~

~~Publisher: History Today Ltd.~~

~~Date: 12 March 2021~~

~~URL: www.historytoday.com/scottsboro-impact~~

~~Answer:~~

~~Carter, James. "The Impact of the Scottsboro Trials." History Today, History Today Ltd., 12 Mar. 2021, www.historytoday.com/scottsboro-impact.~~

Part IV: Grammar & Conventions

Commas with FANBOYS

28. Which sentence uses a comma correctly with a coordinating conjunction? Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2 – Demonstrate command of the conventions of standard English capitalization, punctuation, and spelling when writing.

A. I wanted to go to the game but I had homework. B. I wanted to go to the game, but I had homework. C. I wanted, to go to the game but I had homework. D. I wanted to go to the game but, I had homework.

Answer: B

29. Which sentence needs a comma? Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. She studied hard for the test and passed easily. B. He ran quickly but missed the bus. C. I finished my essay but I forgot to print it. D. They laughed and joked all night.

Answer: C

30. Choose the sentence that is punctuated correctly. Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. The storm was strong, so we stayed inside. B. The storm was strong so, we stayed inside. C. The storm, was strong so we stayed inside. D. The storm was strong so we, stayed inside.

Answer: A

31. Which sentence is correct? Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. I like coffee, and tea. B. I like coffee and, tea. C. I like coffee and tea. D. I like, coffee and tea.

Answer: C

32. Which sentence is correct? Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. I wanted pizza, but my sister wanted pasta. B. I wanted pizza but, my sister wanted pasta. C. I wanted pizza but my sister, wanted pasta. D. I wanted, pizza but my sister wanted pasta.

Answer: A

Semicolon Use

33. Which sentence uses a semicolon correctly? Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. I have a big test tomorrow; and I need to study. B. I have a big test tomorrow; I need to study. C. I have; a big test tomorrow I need to study. D. I have a big test; tomorrow I need to study.

Answer: B

34. Which sentence is punctuated correctly? Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. She loves to dance; however, she is very shy. B. She loves to dance, however she is very shy. C. She loves to dance; however she is very shy. D. She loves to dance however; she is very shy.

Answer: A

35. Which option correctly combines the sentences? The movie was sold out. We decided to go home. Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. The movie was sold out, we decided to go home. B. The movie was sold out; we decided to go home. C. The movie was sold out and we decided to go home. D. The movie was sold out we decided to go home.

Answer: B

36. When should a semicolon be used? Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. To separate a dependent clause from an independent clause B. To join two closely related independent clauses C. Before every coordinating conjunction D. To introduce a list

Answer: B

Apostrophe Use (Possession & Contractions)

37. Which sentence uses an apostrophe correctly? Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. The dogs bone was buried in the yard. B. The dog's bone was buried in the yard. C. The dogs' bone was buried in the yard. D. The dog's' bone was buried in the yard.

Answer: B

38. Which sentence is correct? Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. Its going to rain later. B. It's going to rain later. C. Its' going to rain later. D. It's' going to rain later.

Answer: B

39. Which sentence shows correct plural possession? Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. The girls locker room is upstairs. B. The girl's locker room is upstairs. C. The girls' locker room is upstairs. D. The girls's locker room is upstairs.

Answer: C

40. Choose the correct sentence. Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. James's car is parked outside. B. James car is parked outside. C. James' car are parked outside. D. James's car are parked outside.

Answer: A

41. Which sentence shows correct singular possession? Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. The cat tail is fluffy. B. The cats tail is fluffy. C. The cat's tail is fluffy. D. The cat's' tail is fluffy.

Answer: C

42. Which sentence shows correct plural possession? Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. The teachers lounge is on the second floor. B. The teacher's lounge is on the second floor. C. The teachers' lounge is on the second floor. D. The teacher's' lounge is on the second floor.

Answer: C

43. Which sentence is correct? Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. The children's playground was brand new. B. The childrens playground was brand new. C. The childrens' playground was brand new. D. The children's' playground was brand new.

Answer: A

44. Which sentence is correct? Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. My moms car is red. B. My mom's car is red. C. My moms' car is red. D. My mom car's is red.

Answer: B

Subject/Verb Agreement

45. Which sentence is correct? Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.1 – Demonstrate command of the conventions of standard English grammar and usage when writing or speaking.

A. The team are winning the game. B. The team is winning the game. C. The team were winning the game. D. The team have winning the game.

Answer: B

46. Which sentence shows correct subject/verb agreement? Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.1

A. Everyone in the class have finished the test. B. Everyone in the class has finished the test. C. Everyone in the class are finished the test. D. Everyone in the class finish the test.

Answer: B

47. Choose the correct sentence. Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.1

A. The list of items are on the desk. B. The list of items is on the desk. C. The list of items were on the desk. D. The list of items be on the desk.

Answer: B

48. Which sentence is correct? Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.1

A. Neither of the boys were late. B. Neither of the boys are late. C. Neither of the boys was late. D. Neither of the boys be late.

Answer: C

Independent vs. Dependent Clauses

49. Which of the following is an independent clause? Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.1

A. Although she was tired B. Because it was raining C. When the bell rang D. She finished her homework

Answer: D

50. Which of the following is a dependent clause? Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.1

A. I went to the store. B. We watched a movie. C. After the game ended D. She sings beautifully.

Answer: C

51. In the sentence below, which part is the dependent clause? Although he practiced every day, he still felt nervous. Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.1

A. he still felt nervous B. Although he practiced every day C. he practiced every day D. he felt nervous

Answer: B

52. Choose the sentence that contains two independent clauses. Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.1

A. Because she studied hard, she passed the test. B. After the storm ended, the sun appeared. C. The sun appeared, and the birds began to sing. D. When the bell rang, the students left.

Answer: C

Part V: Reading Comprehension – Short Passage

The carnival arrived without warning, spilling color into the gray afternoon. Bright banners snapped in the wind, and the scent of fried dough drifted lazily through the streets. Yet beneath the cheerful music and flashing lights, something uneasy stirred. The Ferris wheel creaked like an old man rising from sleep, and the ticket seller's smile seemed painted on, stiff and unnatural.

Mara lingered at the entrance, her excitement flickering like a faulty bulb. The laughter around her felt forced, brittle enough to shatter. When the lights suddenly dimmed and the music warped into a low hum, the carnival no longer felt magical—it felt watchful.

RL.9-10.4 Questions with Standards

53. In the first sentence, the word "spilling" most strongly suggests that the carnival

A. arrived in an organized manner B. brought sudden and overwhelming change C. was poorly planned D. created a literal mess

Standard: RL.9-10.4 – Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in the text, including figurative meanings.

54. What is the effect of describing the Ferris wheel as "creaked like an old man rising from sleep"?

A. It creates humor. B. It emphasizes excitement and energy. C. It contributes to an eerie and uneasy tone. D. It suggests the carnival is modern and new.

Standard: RL.9-10.4 – Analyze the impact of figurative language on meaning and tone.

55. In the phrase "her excitement flickering like a faulty bulb," the word flickering suggests that Mara's excitement is

A. growing stronger B. steady and bright C. unstable and fading D. completely gone

Standard: RL.9-10.4 – Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in the text, including figurative meanings.

56. The description of the ticket seller's smile as "painted on, stiff and unnatural" most strongly implies that the smile is

A. joyful and welcoming B. forced and insincere C. proud and confident D. shy and nervous

Standard: RL.9-10.4 – Analyze the cumulative impact of specific word choices on meaning and tone.

57. How does the cumulative effect of words like uneasy, creaked, brittle, warped, and watchful impact the overall tone of the passage?

A. It creates a playful and festive tone. B. It builds a mysterious and suspenseful tone. C. It establishes a romantic tone. D. It creates a nostalgic tone.

Standard: RL.9-10.4 – Analyze the cumulative impact of specific word choices on meaning and tone.

Part VI: Writing Standards – W.9-10.4

Produce clear and coherent writing in which the development, organization, and style are appropriate to task, purpose, and audience.

58. Audience Awareness (W.9-10.4 – style appropriate to audience)

Maria is writing about the dangers of distracted driving. Which introduction is most appropriate if her audience is a group of middle school students?

A. "According to the National Highway Traffic Safety Administration, cognitive distraction significantly impairs reaction time." B. "You might think checking a text while driving is harmless—but it can change someone's life forever." C. "The statistical correlation between mobile device usage and vehicular fatalities has risen exponentially." D. "This essay will analyze the sociological implications of technological dependency."

Answer: B

59. Adjusting Style to Purpose (W.9-10.4 – appropriate tone and style)

A student is writing a formal letter to the school board requesting healthier lunch options. Which sentence best matches the task and purpose?

A. "You guys really need to fix the lunch situation ASAP." B. "I strongly urge the board to consider expanding the availability of nutritious meal options for students." C. "The food is kinda gross and nobody likes it." D. "Lunch is bad. Something should change."

Answer: B

60. Organization and Coherence (W.9-10.4 – clear organization)

Which outline shows the clearest organization for an argumentative essay?

A. Opinion → Random Facts → Conclusion → Counterclaim B. Hook → Claim → Evidence and Explanation → Counterclaim → Conclusion C. Evidence → Hook → Claim → Conclusion D. Counterclaim → Evidence → Hook → Opinion

Answer: B

61. Maintaining Formal Style (W.9-10.4 – style appropriate to task)

Jamal is writing a research paper for English class. Which sentence should he revise to maintain a formal style?

A. "The author develops the theme through symbolism and imagery." B. "The data clearly supports the claim presented in the study." C. "This experiment totally proves the point." D. "The results demonstrate a consistent pattern."

Answer: C

62. Development of Ideas (W.9-10.4 – effective development)

Which body paragraph best demonstrates effective development for an essay arguing that schools should start later?

A. "Schools should start later because students are tired." B. "Many students dislike waking up early for school." C. "Studies from medical organizations show that teenagers' sleep cycles naturally shift later at night, making early start times harmful to their health and academic performance." D. "Starting school early is just how it has always been."

Answer: C

63. Matching Writing to Task (W.9-10.4 – appropriate to task and purpose)

A student is asked to write a narrative about overcoming a challenge. Which response best fits the task?

A. A five-paragraph essay explaining the causes of climate change B. A story describing a time the writer struggled in a difficult class and learned persistence C. A persuasive letter arguing for more homework D. A summary of a news article about athletes

Answer: B

xcerpt:
“You never really understand a person until you consider things from his point of view… until you climb into his skin and walk around in it.”

The phrase “climb into his skin and walk around in it” most nearly means:

A. Spy on someone secretly
B. Physically fight someone
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2. (RL.9-10.2) Short Response

Based on the excerpt above, identify one theme of the novel and explain how this quote helps develop that theme.

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Excerpt:
"Atticus was feeble: he was nearly fifty."

In this context, the word *feeble* most nearly means: _____.

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Excerpt (Atticus defending Tom Robinson):
"In the name of God, do your duty."

Which theme is most strongly reinforced in this moment?

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"Maycomb was an old town, but it was a tired old town when I first knew it."

The word *tired* most strongly suggests:

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The phrase "learn from scratch" most nearly means: _____.

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"In 1931, nine Black teenagers were falsely accused of assault. Despite weak evidence, all-white juries quickly convicted them."

The central idea of this excerpt is:

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B. The boys were guilty of their crimes.
C. Racial prejudice influenced the trials and verdicts.
D. The South had strong juries.

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10. (RI.9-10.4) Fill in the Blank

In the sentence above, the word *convicted* most nearly means:
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11. (RI.9-10.2) Short Response

Explain how the Scottsboro case provides historical context for *To Kill a Mockingbird*.

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Excerpt about Emmett Till:
"In 1955, Emmett Till's murder and the acquittal of his killers shocked the nation and became a catalyst for the Civil Rights Movement."

The phrase *catalyst* suggests that the event:

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The word *acquittal* most nearly means: _____.

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Excerpt about Harper Lee:
"Harper Lee grew up in Alabama and observed racial inequality firsthand, experiences that later shaped her writing."

The central idea is:

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C. Lee disliked Alabama.
D. Lee based her novel entirely on fiction.

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D. "Real courage is when you know you're licked before you begin…" (TKAM 112).

Answer: A

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Rewrite the sentence using a correct MLA signal phrase:

“Mockingbirds don’t do one thing but make music for us to enjoy” (Lee 119).

Corrected sentence:
According to _____, “Mockingbirds don’t do one thing but make music for us to enjoy” (119).

Answer: Harper Lee

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B. Atticus argues that “the one place where a man ought to get a square deal is in a courtroom.” (Lee 205)
C. Atticus argues that “the one place where a man ought to get a square deal is in a courtroom” Lee 205.
D. Atticus argues that “the one place where a man ought to get a square deal is in a courtroom.” Lee (205).

Answer: A

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21. (W.9-10.9) Short Response – Integrating Research

Write one sentence that properly integrates evidence from a nonfiction source about the Scottsboro Boys using a signal phrase and MLA parenthetical citation (author last name and page number format).

Answer (Sample Response):
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D. Lee Harper. *To Kill a Mockingbird* Harper, 2006.

Answer: A

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In MLA 9, every Works Cited entry after the first line should use a _____.

Answer: hanging indent

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Answer: B

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Title: "The Impact of the Scottsboro Trials"
Website: *History Today*
Publisher: History Today Ltd.
Date: 12 March 2021
URL: www.historytoday.com/scottsboro-impact

Answer:

Carter, James. "The Impact of the Scottsboro Trials." *History Today*, History Today Ltd., 12 Mar. 2021, www.historytoday.com/scottsboro-impact.

1. Which sentence uses a comma correctly with a coordinating conjunction?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2 – Demonstrate command of the conventions of standard English capitalization, punctuation, and spelling when writing.

A. I wanted to go to the game but I had homework.
B. I wanted to go to the game, but I had homework.
C. I wanted, to go to the game but I had homework.
D. I wanted to go to the game but, I had homework.

Answer: B

---

2. Which sentence needs a comma?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. She studied hard for the test and passed easily.
B. He ran quickly but missed the bus.
C. I finished my essay but I forgot to print it.
D. They laughed and joked all night.

Answer: C

---

3. Choose the sentence that is punctuated correctly.
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. The storm was strong, so we stayed inside.
B. The storm was strong so, we stayed inside.
C. The storm, was strong so we stayed inside.
D. The storm was strong so we, stayed inside.

Answer: A

---

4. Which sentence is correct?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. I like coffee, and tea.
B. I like coffee and, tea.
C. I like coffee and tea.
D. I like, coffee and tea.

Answer: C

---

5. Which sentence is correct?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. I wanted pizza, but my sister wanted pasta.
B. I wanted pizza but, my sister wanted pasta.
C. I wanted pizza but my sister, wanted pasta.
D. I wanted, pizza but my sister wanted pasta.

Answer: A

Semicolon Use

6. Which sentence uses a semicolon correctly?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. I have a big test tomorrow; and I need to study.
B. I have a big test tomorrow; I need to study.
C. I have; a big test tomorrow I need to study.
D. I have a big test; tomorrow I need to study.

Answer: B

---

7. Which sentence is punctuated correctly?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. She loves to dance; however, she is very shy.
B. She loves to dance, however she is very shy.
C. She loves to dance; however she is very shy.
D. She loves to dance however; she is very shy.

Answer: A

---

8. Which option correctly combines the sentences?
The movie was sold out. We decided to go home.
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. The movie was sold out, we decided to go home.
B. The movie was sold out; we decided to go home.
C. The movie was sold out and we decided to go home.
D. The movie was sold out we decided to go home.

Answer: B

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9. When should a semicolon be used?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. To separate a dependent clause from an independent clause
B. To join two closely related independent clauses
C. Before every coordinating conjunction
D. To introduce a list

Answer: B

Apostrophe Use (Possession & Contractions)

10. Which sentence uses an apostrophe correctly?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. The dogs bone was buried in the yard.
B. The dog's bone was buried in the yard.
C. The dogs' bone was buried in the yard.
D. The dog's' bone was buried in the yard.

Answer: B

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11. Which sentence is correct?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. Its going to rain later.
B. It's going to rain later.
C. Its' going to rain later.
D. It’s' going to rain later.

Answer: B

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12. Which sentence shows correct plural possession?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. The girls locker room is upstairs.
B. The girl's locker room is upstairs.
C. The girls' locker room is upstairs.
D. The girls's locker room is upstairs.

Answer: C

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13. Choose the correct sentence.
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. James's car is parked outside.
B. James car is parked outside.

C. James' car are parked outside.
D. James's car are parked outside.

Answer: A

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14. Which sentence shows correct singular possession?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. The cat tail is fluffy.
B. The cats tail is fluffy.
C. The cat's tail is fluffy.
D. The cat's' tail is fluffy.

Answer: C

---

15. Which sentence shows correct plural possession?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. The teachers lounge is on the second floor.
B. The teacher's lounge is on the second floor.
C. The teachers' lounge is on the second floor.
D. The teacher's' lounge is on the second floor.

Answer: C

---

16. Which sentence is correct?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. The children's playground was brand new.
B. The childrens playground was brand new.
C. The childrens' playground was brand new.
D. The children's' playground was brand new.

Answer: A

---

17. Which sentence is correct?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. My moms car is red.
B. My mom's car is red.
C. My moms' car is red.
D. My mom car's is red.

Answer: B

Subject/Verb Agreement

18. Which sentence is correct?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.1 – Demonstrate command of the conventions of standard English grammar and usage when writing or speaking.

A. The team are winning the game.
B. The team is winning the game.
C. The team were winning the game.
D. The team have winning the game.

Answer: B

---

19. Which sentence shows correct subject/verb agreement?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.1

A. Everyone in the class have finished the test.
B. Everyone in the class has finished the test.
C. Everyone in the class are finished the test.
D. Everyone in the class finish the test.

Answer: B

---

20. Choose the correct sentence.
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.1

A. The list of items are on the desk.
B. The list of items is on the desk.
C. The list of items were on the desk.
D. The list of items be on the desk.

Answer: B

---

21. Which sentence is correct?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.1

A. Neither of the boys were late.
B. Neither of the boys are late.
C. Neither of the boys was late.
D. Neither of the boys be late.

Answer: C

Independent vs. Dependent Clauses

22. Which of the following is an independent clause?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.1

A. Although she was tired
B. Because it was raining
C. When the bell rang
D. She finished her homework

Answer: D

---

23. Which of the following is a dependent clause?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.1

A. I went to the store.
B. We watched a movie.
C. After the game ended
D. She sings beautifully.

Answer: C

---

24. In the sentence below, which part is the dependent clause?
Although he practiced every day, he still felt nervous.
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.1

A. he still felt nervous
B. Although he practiced every day

C. he practiced every day
D. he felt nervous

Answer: B

---

25. Choose the sentence that contains two independent clauses.
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.1

A. Because she studied hard, she passed the test.
B. After the storm ended, the sun appeared.
C. The sun appeared, and the birds began to sing.
D. When the bell rang, the students left.

Answer: C

Short Passage

The carnival arrived without warning, spilling color into the gray afternoon. Bright banners snapped in the wind, and the scent of fried dough drifted lazily through the streets. Yet beneath the cheerful music and flashing lights, something uneasy stirred. The Ferris wheel creaked like an old man rising from sleep, and the ticket seller's smile seemed painted on, stiff and unnatural.

Mara lingered at the entrance, her excitement flickering like a faulty bulb. The laughter around her felt forced, brittle enough to shatter. When the lights suddenly dimmed and the music warped into a low hum, the carnival no longer felt magical—it felt watchful.

RL.9-10.4 Questions with Standards

1. In the first sentence, the word *"spilling"* most strongly suggests that the carnival
A. arrived in an organized manner
B. brought sudden and overwhelming change
C. was poorly planned
D. created a literal mess

Standard: RL.9-10.4 – Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in the text, including figurative meanings.

---

2. What is the effect of describing the Ferris wheel as *"creaked like an old man rising from sleep"*?
A. It creates humor.
B. It emphasizes excitement and energy.
C. It contributes to an eerie and uneasy tone.
D. It suggests the carnival is modern and new.

Standard: RL.9-10.4 – Analyze the impact of figurative language on meaning and tone.

---

3. In the phrase *"her excitement flickering like a faulty bulb,"* the word *flickering* suggests that Mara's excitement is
A. growing stronger
B. steady and bright
C. unstable and fading
D. completely gone

Standard: RL.9-10.4 – Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in the text, including figurative meanings.

---

4. The description of the ticket seller's smile as *"painted on, stiff and unnatural"* most strongly implies that the smile is
A. joyful and welcoming
B. forced and insincere
C. proud and confident
D. shy and nervous

Standard: RL.9-10.4 – Analyze the cumulative impact of specific word choices on meaning and tone.

---

5. How does the cumulative effect of words like *uneasy, creaked, brittle, warped,* and *watchful* impact the overall tone of the passage?
A. It creates a playful and festive tone.
B. It builds a mysterious and suspenseful tone.
C. It establishes a romantic tone.
D. It creates a nostalgic tone.

Standard: RL.9-10.4 – Analyze the cumulative impact of specific word choices on meaning and tone.

Common Core Standard: W.9-10.4

Produce clear and coherent writing in which the development, organization, and style are appropriate to task, purpose, and audience.

---

1. Audience Awareness (W.9-10.4 – style appropriate to audience)

Maria is writing about the dangers of distracted driving. Which introduction is most appropriate if her audience is a group of middle school students?

A. “According to the National Highway Traffic Safety Administration, cognitive distraction significantly impairs reaction time.”
B. “You might think checking a text while driving is harmless—but it can change someone’s life forever.”
C. “The statistical correlation between mobile device usage and vehicular fatalities has risen exponentially.”
D. “This essay will analyze the sociological implications of technological dependency.”

Answer: B

---

2. Adjusting Style to Purpose (W.9-10.4 – appropriate tone and style)

A student is writing a formal letter to the school board requesting healthier lunch options. Which sentence best matches the task and purpose?

A. “You guys really need to fix the lunch situation ASAP.”
B. “I strongly urge the board to consider expanding the availability of nutritious meal options for students.”
C. “The food is kinda gross and nobody likes it.”
D. “Lunch is bad. Something should change.”

Answer: B

---

3. Organization and Coherence (W.9-10.4 – clear organization)

Which outline shows the clearest organization for an argumentative essay?

A. Opinion → Random Facts → Conclusion → Counterclaim
B. Hook → Claim → Evidence and Explanation → Counterclaim → Conclusion
C. Evidence → Hook → Claim → Conclusion
D. Counterclaim → Evidence → Hook → Opinion

Answer: B

---

4. Maintaining Formal Style (W.9-10.4 – style appropriate to task)

Jamal is writing a research paper for English class. Which sentence should he revise to maintain a formal style?

A. “The author develops the theme through symbolism and imagery.”
B. “The data clearly supports the claim presented in the study.”
C. “This experiment totally proves the point.”
D. “The results demonstrate a consistent pattern.”

Answer: C

---

5. Development of Ideas (W.9-10.4 – effective development)

Which body paragraph best demonstrates effective development for an essay arguing that schools should start later?

A. “Schools should start later because students are tired.”
B. “Many students dislike waking up early for school.”
C. “Studies from medical organizations show that teenagers’ sleep cycles naturally shift later at night, making early start times harmful to their health and academic performance.”
D. “Starting school early is just how it has always been.”

Answer: C

---

6. Matching Writing to Task (W.9-10.4 – appropriate to task and purpose)

A student is asked to write a narrative about overcoming a challenge. Which response best fits the task?

A. A five-paragraph essay explaining the causes of climate change
B. A story describing a time the writer struggled in a difficult class and learned persistence
C. A persuasive letter arguing for more homework
D. A summary of a news article about athletes

Answer: B

1. Which sentence uses a comma correctly with a coordinating conjunction?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2 – Demonstrate command of the conventions of standard English capitalization, punctuation, and spelling when writing.

A. I wanted to go to the game but I had homework.
B. I wanted to go to the game, but I had homework.
C. I wanted, to go to the game but I had homework.
D. I wanted to go to the game but, I had homework.

Answer: B

---

2. Which sentence needs a comma?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. She studied hard for the test and passed easily.
B. He ran quickly but missed the bus.
C. I finished my essay but I forgot to print it.
D. They laughed and joked all night.

Answer: C

---

3. Choose the sentence that is punctuated correctly.
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. The storm was strong, so we stayed inside.
B. The storm was strong so, we stayed inside.
C. The storm, was strong so we stayed inside.
D. The storm was strong so we, stayed inside.

Answer: A

---

4. Which sentence is correct?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. I like coffee, and tea.
B. I like coffee and, tea.
C. I like coffee and tea.
D. I like, coffee and tea.

Answer: C

---

5. Which sentence is correct?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. I wanted pizza, but my sister wanted pasta.
B. I wanted pizza but, my sister wanted pasta.
C. I wanted pizza but my sister, wanted pasta.
D. I wanted, pizza but my sister wanted pasta.

Answer: A

Semicolon Use

6. Which sentence uses a semicolon correctly?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. I have a big test tomorrow; and I need to study.
B. I have a big test tomorrow; I need to study.

C. I have; a big test tomorrow I need to study.
D. I have a big test; tomorrow I need to study.

Answer: B

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7. Which sentence is punctuated correctly?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. She loves to dance; however, she is very shy.
B. She loves to dance, however she is very shy.
C. She loves to dance; however she is very shy.
D. She loves to dance however; she is very shy.

Answer: A

---

8. Which option correctly combines the sentences?
The movie was sold out. We decided to go home.
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. The movie was sold out, we decided to go home.
B. The movie was sold out; we decided to go home.
C. The movie was sold out and we decided to go home.
D. The movie was sold out we decided to go home.

Answer: B

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9. When should a semicolon be used?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. To separate a dependent clause from an independent clause
B. To join two closely related independent clauses
C. Before every coordinating conjunction
D. To introduce a list

Answer: B

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10. Which sentence uses an apostrophe correctly?
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B. The dog's bone was buried in the yard.
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---

11. Which sentence is correct?
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A. Its going to rain later.
B. It's going to rain later.
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12. Which sentence shows correct plural possession?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. The girls locker room is upstairs.
B. The girl's locker room is upstairs.
C. The girls' locker room is upstairs.
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Answer: C

---

13. Choose the correct sentence.
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. James's car is parked outside.
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14. Which sentence shows correct singular possession?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

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15. Which sentence shows correct plural possession?
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A. The teachers lounge is on the second floor.
B. The teacher's lounge is on the second floor.
C. The teachers' lounge is on the second floor.
D. The teacher's' lounge is on the second floor.

Answer: C

---

16. Which sentence is correct?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. The children's playground was brand new.
B. The childrens playground was brand new.
C. The childrens' playground was brand new.
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Answer: A

---

17. Which sentence is correct?
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A. My moms car is red.
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Subject/Verb Agreement

18. Which sentence is correct?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.1 – Demonstrate command of the conventions of standard English grammar and usage when writing or speaking.

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B. Everyone in the class has finished the test.
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D. Everyone in the class finish the test.

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20. Choose the correct sentence.
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21. Which sentence is correct?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.1

A. Neither of the boys were late.
B. Neither of the boys are late.
C. Neither of the boys was late.
D. Neither of the boys be late.

Answer: C

Independent vs. Dependent Clauses

22. Which of the following is an independent clause?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.1

A. Although she was tired
B. Because it was raining
C. When the bell rang
D. She finished her homework

Answer: D

---

23. Which of the following is a dependent clause?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.1

A. I went to the store.
B. We watched a movie.
C. After the game ended
D. She sings beautifully.

Answer: C

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24. In the sentence below, which part is the dependent clause?
Although he practiced every day, he still felt nervous.
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.1

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B. Although he practiced every day
C. he practiced every day
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25. Choose the sentence that contains two independent clauses.
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.1

A. Because she studied hard, she passed the test.
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RL.9-10.4 Questions with Standards

1. In the first sentence, the word *"spilling"* most strongly suggests that the carnival
A. arrived in an organized manner
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Standard: RL.9-10.4 – Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in the text, including figurative meanings.

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2. What is the effect of describing the Ferris wheel as *“creaked like an old man rising from sleep”*?
A. It creates humor.
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D. It suggests the carnival is modern and new.

Standard: RL.9-10.4 – Analyze the impact of figurative language on meaning and tone.

---

3. In the phrase *“her excitement flickering like a faulty bulb,”* the word *flickering* suggests that Mara’s excitement is
A. growing stronger
B. steady and bright
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D. completely gone

Standard: RL.9-10.4 – Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in the text, including figurative meanings.

---

4. The description of the ticket seller’s smile as *“painted on, stiff and unnatural”* most strongly implies that the smile is
A. joyful and welcoming
B. forced and insincere
C. proud and confident
D. shy and nervous

Standard: RL.9-10.4 – Analyze the cumulative impact of specific word choices on meaning and tone.

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5. How does the cumulative effect of words like *uneasy, creaked, brittle, warped,* and *watchful* impact the overall tone of the passage?
A. It creates a playful and festive tone.
B. It builds a mysterious and suspenseful tone.
C. It establishes a romantic tone.
D. It creates a nostalgic tone.

Standard: RL.9-10.4 – Analyze the cumulative impact of specific word choices on meaning and tone.

Common Core Standard: W.9-10.4

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---

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D. “This essay will analyze the sociological implications of technological dependency.”

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2. Adjusting Style to Purpose (W.9-10.4 – appropriate tone and style)

A student is writing a formal letter to the school board requesting healthier lunch options. Which sentence best matches the task and purpose?

A. “You guys really need to fix the lunch situation ASAP.”
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Which outline shows the clearest organization for an argumentative essay?

A. Opinion → Random Facts → Conclusion → Counterclaim
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C. Evidence → Hook → Claim → Conclusion
D. Counterclaim → Evidence → Hook → Opinion

Answer: B

---

4. Maintaining Formal Style (W.9-10.4 – style appropriate to task)

Jamal is writing a research paper for English class. Which sentence should he revise to maintain a formal style?

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Which body paragraph best demonstrates effective development for an essay arguing that schools should start later?

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Answer: C

---

6. Matching Writing to Task (W.9-10.4 – appropriate to task and purpose)

A student is asked to write a narrative about overcoming a challenge. Which response best fits the task?

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B. A story describing a time the writer struggled in a difficult class and learned persistence
C. A persuasive letter arguing for more homework
D. A summary of a news article about athletes

Answer: B

Commas with FANBOYS

1. Which sentence uses a comma correctly with a coordinating conjunction?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2 – Demonstrate command of the conventions of standard English capitalization, punctuation, and spelling when writing.

A. I wanted to go to the game but I had homework.
B. I wanted to go to the game, but I had homework.
C. I wanted, to go to the game but I had homework.
D. I wanted to go to the game but, I had homework.

Answer: B

---

2. Which sentence needs a comma?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. She studied hard for the test and passed easily.
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C. I finished my essay but I forgot to print it.
D. They laughed and joked all night.

Answer: C

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3. Choose the sentence that is punctuated correctly.
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. The storm was strong, so we stayed inside.
B. The storm was strong so, we stayed inside.
C. The storm, was strong so we stayed inside.
D. The storm was strong so we, stayed inside.

Answer: A

---

4. Which sentence is correct?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. I like coffee, and tea.
B. I like coffee and, tea.
C. I like coffee and tea.
D. I like, coffee and tea.

Answer: C

---

5. Which sentence is correct?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. I wanted pizza, but my sister wanted pasta.
B. I wanted pizza but, my sister wanted pasta.
C. I wanted pizza but my sister, wanted pasta.
D. I wanted, pizza but my sister wanted pasta.

Answer: A

Semicolon Use

6. Which sentence uses a semicolon correctly?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. I have a big test tomorrow; and I need to study.
B. I have a big test tomorrow; I need to study.
C. I have; a big test tomorrow I need to study.
D. I have a big test; tomorrow I need to study.

Answer: B

---

7. Which sentence is punctuated correctly?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. She loves to dance; however, she is very shy.
B. She loves to dance, however she is very shy.
C. She loves to dance; however she is very shy.
D. She loves to dance however; she is very shy.

Answer: A

---

8. Which option correctly combines the sentences?
The movie was sold out. We decided to go home.
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. The movie was sold out, we decided to go home.
B. The movie was sold out; we decided to go home.
C. The movie was sold out and we decided to go home.
D. The movie was sold out we decided to go home.

Answer: B

---

9. When should a semicolon be used?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. To separate a dependent clause from an independent clause
B. To join two closely related independent clauses
C. Before every coordinating conjunction
D. To introduce a list

Answer: B

Apostrophe Use (Possession & Contractions)

10. Which sentence uses an apostrophe correctly?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. The dogs bone was buried in the yard.
B. The dog's bone was buried in the yard.
C. The dogs' bone was buried in the yard.
D. The dog's' bone was buried in the yard.

Answer: B

---

11. Which sentence is correct?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. Its going to rain later.
B. It's going to rain later.
C. Its' going to rain later.
D. It’s' going to rain later.

Answer: B

---

12. Which sentence shows correct plural possession?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. The girls locker room is upstairs.
B. The girl's locker room is upstairs.
C. The girls' locker room is upstairs.
D. The girls's locker room is upstairs.

Answer: C

---

13. Choose the correct sentence.
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. James's car is parked outside.
B. James car is parked outside.
C. James' car are parked outside.
D. James's car are parked outside.

Answer: A

---

14. Which sentence shows correct singular possession?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. The cat tail is fluffy.
B. The cats tail is fluffy.
C. The cat's tail is fluffy.
D. The cat's' tail is fluffy.

Answer: C

---

15. Which sentence shows correct plural possession?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. The teachers lounge is on the second floor.
B. The teacher's lounge is on the second floor.
C. The teachers' lounge is on the second floor.
D. The teacher's' lounge is on the second floor.

Answer: C

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16. Which sentence is correct?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. The children's playground was brand new.
B. The childrens playground was brand new.
C. The childrens' playground was brand new.
D. The children's' playground was brand new.

Answer: A

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17. Which sentence is correct?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.2

A. My moms car is red.
B. My mom's car is red.
C. My moms' car is red.
D. My mom car's is red.

Answer: B

Subject/Verb Agreement

18. Which sentence is correct?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.1 – Demonstrate command of the conventions of standard English grammar and usage when writing or speaking.

A. The team are winning the game.
B. The team is winning the game.

C. The team were winning the game.
D. The team have winning the game.

Answer: B

---

19. Which sentence shows correct subject/verb agreement?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.1

A. Everyone in the class have finished the test.
B. Everyone in the class has finished the test.
C. Everyone in the class are finished the test.
D. Everyone in the class finish the test.

Answer: B

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20. Choose the correct sentence.
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.1

A. The list of items are on the desk.
B. The list of items is on the desk.
C. The list of items were on the desk.
D. The list of items be on the desk.

Answer: B

---

21. Which sentence is correct?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.1

A. Neither of the boys were late.
B. Neither of the boys are late.
C. Neither of the boys was late.
D. Neither of the boys be late.

Answer: C

Independent vs. Dependent Clauses

22. Which of the following is an independent clause?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.1

A. Although she was tired
B. Because it was raining
C. When the bell rang
D. She finished her homework

Answer: D

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23. Which of the following is a dependent clause?
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.1

A. I went to the store.
B. We watched a movie.
C. After the game ended
D. She sings beautifully.

Answer: C

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24. In the sentence below, which part is the dependent clause?
Although he practiced every day, he still felt nervous.
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.1

A. he still felt nervous
B. Although he practiced every day
C. he practiced every day
D. he felt nervous

Answer: B

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25. Choose the sentence that contains two independent clauses.
Standard: CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.L.9-10.1

A. Because she studied hard, she passed the test.
B. After the storm ended, the sun appeared.
C. The sun appeared, and the birds began to sing.
D. When the bell rang, the students left.

Answer: C

Short Passage

The carnival arrived without warning, spilling color into the gray afternoon. Bright banners snapped in the wind, and the scent of fried dough drifted lazily through the streets. Yet beneath the cheerful music and flashing lights, something uneasy stirred. The Ferris wheel creaked like an old man rising from sleep, and the ticket seller's smile seemed painted on, stiff and unnatural.

Mara lingered at the entrance, her excitement flickering like a faulty bulb. The laughter around her felt forced, brittle enough to shatter. When the lights suddenly dimmed and the music warped into a low hum, the carnival no longer felt magical—it felt watchful.

RL.9-10.4 Questions with Standards

1. In the first sentence, the word *"spilling"* most strongly suggests that the carnival
A. arrived in an organized manner
B. brought sudden and overwhelming change
C. was poorly planned
D. created a literal mess

Standard: RL.9-10.4 – Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in the text, including figurative meanings.

---

2. What is the effect of describing the Ferris wheel as *"creaked like an old man rising from sleep"*?
A. It creates humor.
B. It emphasizes excitement and energy.

C. It contributes to an eerie and uneasy tone.
D. It suggests the carnival is modern and new.

Standard: RL.9-10.4 – Analyze the impact of figurative language on meaning and tone.

---

3. In the phrase *"her excitement flickering like a faulty bulb,"* the word *flickering* suggests that Mara's excitement is
A. growing stronger
B. steady and bright
C. unstable and fading
D. completely gone

Standard: RL.9-10.4 – Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in the text, including figurative meanings.

---

4. The description of the ticket seller's smile as *"painted on, stiff and unnatural"* most strongly implies that the smile is
A. joyful and welcoming
B. forced and insincere
C. proud and confident
D. shy and nervous

Standard: RL.9-10.4 – Analyze the cumulative impact of specific word choices on meaning and tone.

---

5. How does the cumulative effect of words like *uneasy, creaked, brittle, warped,* and *watchful* impact the overall tone of the passage?
A. It creates a playful and festive tone.
B. It builds a mysterious and suspenseful tone.
C. It establishes a romantic tone.
D. It creates a nostalgic tone.

Standard: RL.9-10.4 – Analyze the cumulative impact of specific word choices on meaning and tone.

Common Core Standard: W.9-10.4

Produce clear and coherent writing in which the development, organization, and style are appropriate to task, purpose, and audience.

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1. Audience Awareness (W.9-10.4 – style appropriate to audience)

Maria is writing about the dangers of distracted driving. Which introduction is most appropriate if her audience is a group of middle school students?

A. “According to the National Highway Traffic Safety Administration, cognitive distraction significantly impairs reaction time.”
B. “You might think checking a text while driving is harmless—but it can change someone’s life forever.”
C. “The statistical correlation between mobile device usage and vehicular fatalities has risen exponentially.”
D. “This essay will analyze the sociological implications of technological dependency.”

Answer: B

---

2. Adjusting Style to Purpose (W.9-10.4 – appropriate tone and style)

A student is writing a formal letter to the school board requesting healthier lunch options. Which sentence best matches the task and purpose?

A. “You guys really need to fix the lunch situation ASAP.”
B. “I strongly urge the board to consider expanding the availability of nutritious meal options for students.”
C. “The food is kinda gross and nobody likes it.”
D. “Lunch is bad. Something should change.”

Answer: B

---

3. Organization and Coherence (W.9-10.4 – clear organization)

Which outline shows the clearest organization for an argumentative essay?

A. Opinion → Random Facts → Conclusion → Counterclaim
B. Hook → Claim → Evidence and Explanation → Counterclaim → Conclusion
C. Evidence → Hook → Claim → Conclusion
D. Counterclaim → Evidence → Hook → Opinion

Answer: B

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4. Maintaining Formal Style (W.9-10.4 – style appropriate to task)

Jamal is writing a research paper for English class. Which sentence should he revise to maintain a formal style?

A. “The author develops the theme through symbolism and imagery.”
B. “The data clearly supports the claim presented in the study.”
C. “This experiment totally proves the point.”
D. “The results demonstrate a consistent pattern.”

Answer: C

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5. Development of Ideas (W.9-10.4 – effective development)

Which body paragraph best demonstrates effective development for an essay arguing that schools should start later?

A. “Schools should start later because students are tired.”
B. “Many students dislike waking up early for school.”
C. “Studies from medical organizations show that teenagers’ sleep cycles naturally shift later at night, making early start times harmful to their health and academic performance.”
D. “Starting school early is just how it has always been.”

Answer: C

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6. Matching Writing to Task (W.9-10.4 – appropriate to task and purpose)

A student is asked to write a narrative about overcoming a challenge. Which response best fits the task?

A. A five-paragraph essay explaining the causes of climate change
B. A story describing a time the writer struggled in a difficult class and learned persistence
C. A persuasive letter arguing for more homework
D. A summary of a news article about athletes

Answer: B

ENGLISH I FINAL EXAM

Theme & Vocabulary in Context

Part I: Literature – To Kill a Mockingbird

1. (RL.9-10.4) Multiple Choice